



Grammar Lesson 15A — Adverbial Phrase of Time

Malagasy–Tsimihety with Bako

Introduction

The adverbial phrase of time is a word or group of words indicating when an action takes place.

Position

As we have seen previously, in Malagasy the subject comes at the end of the sentence. The adverbial phrase of time is the only word or group of words that can come after the subject.

Predicate — Subject — Adverbial Phrase of Time

Agreement

Predicates (adjectives, verbs) do not agree with the gender or number of the subject. However, the verb and adjective do agree with the tense.

When the time word is introduced by the preposition **amin'ny**, it stays the same in the future but becomes **tamin'ny** in the past.



Ex: Amin'ny Zoma (this Friday) — Tamin'ny Zoma (last Friday)

Examples showing tense:

Mafana ny andro androany (It is hot today) — PRESENT

Nafana ny andro omaly (It was hot yesterday) — PAST

Hafana ny andro rahampitso (It will be hot tomorrow) — FUTURE

Time Words



Days relative to today

Preposition	Official (off)	Tsimihety (tsm)	English
(no preposition)	Afak'omaly Omaly Androany / anio Rahampitso Afaka rahampitso	Afaka nomoaligny Nomoaligny Niagny Amaraigny Afaka amaraigny	The day before yesterday Yesterday Today Tomorrow The day after tomorrow

Times of day



Preposition	Official (off)	Tsimihety (tsm)	English
Amin'ny ... Tamin'ny ... (past)	Maraina Atoandro Tolakandro Hariva Alina	Maraindraigny Matsagna Folakandro Harivariva Aligny	Morning Midday / noon Afternoon Evening Night

Days of the week



Preposition	Official (off)	Tsimihety (tsm)	English
Amin'ny ... Tamin'ny ... (past)	Alatsinainy Talata Alarobia Alakamisy Zomā Asabotsy Alahady	Tinainy Talata Robiā Kamisy Zomā / Jomoā Sabôtsy Lahady / Dimansy	Monday Tuesday Wednesday Thursday Friday Saturday Sunday

Types and Questions



Questions vary according to the type of time word used.

Questions answering "When?"

Past: **Oviana no ...? (off)** / **Tafiriagna ...? (tsm)**

Future: **Rahoviana no ...? (off)** / **Hafiriagna ...? (tsm)**

Examples:

Hiasa izy rahampitso. (He/she will work tomorrow.)

Rahoviana no hiasa izy? (When will he/she work?)

Niasa izy nomoaligny. (He/she worked yesterday.) [tsm]

Tafiriagna izy niasa? (When did he/she work?) [tsm]

Exercise A — Translate into English



"*Miasa izy*" (He / she works)

Niasa izy omaly.

→ He / she worked yesterday.

Tsy miasa izy androany.

→ He / she is not working today.

Hiasa izy afaka rahampitso?

→ Will he / she work the day after tomorrow?

Hiasa ve izy amaraigany?

→ Will he / she work tomorrow? [tsm]

Miasa ve izy niagny?

→ Is he / she working today? [tsm]

Tafiriagna izy niasa?

→ When did he / she work? [tsm]

Hafiriagna izy hiasa?

→ When will he / she work? [tsm]

Oviana no tsy niasa izy?

→ When did he / she not work? [off]

Rahoviana no tsy miasa izy?

→ When will he / she not work? [off]

Exercise B — Translate into English



"Mafana ny andro" (It is hot)

Nafana ny andro tamin'ny maraina.

→ It was hot in the morning.

Tsy mafana ny andro amin'ny alina.

→ It is not hot at night.

Hafana ny andro amin'ny tolakandro.

→ It will be hot in the afternoon.

Tafiriagna nafana ny andro?

→ When was it hot? [tsm]

Rahoviana no hafana ny andro?

→ When will it be hot? [off]

Exercise C — Translate into English



"Tonga ny vahiny" (The visitor has arrived / the visitors have arrived)

Tonga ny vahiny tamin'ny Talata.

→ The visitor(s) arrived on Tuesday.

Tonga ny vahiny tamin'ny Lahady.

→ The visitor(s) arrived on Sunday. [tsm: Lahady]

Tonga ny vahiny tamin'ny Sabotsy maraina.

→ The visitor(s) arrived on Saturday morning.

Tsy ho tonga ny vahiny amin'ny Zomā.

→ The visitor(s) will not arrive on Friday.

Ho tonga ny vahiny amin'ny Robiā.

→ The visitor(s) will arrive on Wednesday. [tsm: Robiā]

Tafiriagna tonga ny vahiny?

→ When did the visitor(s) arrive? [tsm]

Hafiriagna ho tonga ny vahiny?

→ When will the visitor(s) arrive? [tsm]